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Rural Hausa

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Abakuru (Bakuru). Tiny cakes made from groundnuts, bean flour, etc.

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Aboki - f. *abokiya*, pl. *abokai* . A friend or companion; also one who shares in something, e.g. *abokin aiki*, a fellow-worker. See Arziki, Kawa.

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Abokin wasa. The 'joking-relationship' between certain friends, occupational groups, and categories of kin, the latter including cross-cousins, grandparents (and grandchildren) and a younger brother of a husband or wife. See Smith (1955, pp. 43-5).

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Abubakar Labo . Abubakar Labo of Kaukai (q.v.) who was a most valued informant in 1967 and 1968 on long-distance trading (*fatauci*), the tobacco trade, slavery, the cowry currency, the history of markets, and other historical matters, was in Damagaram (Zinder) with his father (Geshe), who was a famous caravan-leader, during the reign of Sarki Ahmadu (1893-9). His father was himself the son of a ruraly-based *farke*, who had lived in Makurdi (q.v.): he had been on *fatauci* to Lagos before 1900, knew Agadez well, and regarded Damagaram as a 'second home'.

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Acacia: see Gawo, **Mimosa** .

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Acakwa. **Raphia** (*gwangwala*) tray for carrying a load.

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Burden Carrying

Acca. 'Hungry rice' (*Digitaria exilis*), known as *intaya* in Zaria. The evidence is that this grain is seldom cultivated by the Hausa.

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Adada - pl. *adadai* . Rectangular thatched house or room.

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Adashi.

(a) A 'rotating credit association' (or contribution club) such that each member undertakes to pay, usually weekly, a certain sum of money into a common pool for a fixed period, a different member drawing the total fund on each occasion, until each has had her share. Nearly all *adashi* members are women and each group is run by a woman (*uwar adashi* - lit. 'mother of the *adashi*') who collects the contributions (sometimes through the medium of children), selects the weekly beneficiary and generally organizes affairs, in return for a small commission payable by each beneficiary. When contributions are payable weekly (as they often are) the *adashi* usually lasts for 30 weeks, having the same number of members. The weekly contributions (*zubi*) vary between 1 *d.* and 2 *s.* The last person to receive the weekly pay-out (*kwasa*) is known as *kutal* (the end of a queue) - she may be compensated by drawing the first *kwasa* in the next *adashi* . When a member fails to pay the *zubi* due, the *uwar adashi* herself becomes liable. About four-fifths of all Batagarawa women participate in *adashi* . Nearly every woman aspires to coagulate her savings in this way and membership of several groups is common.

(b) In Hausa towns certain men (e.g. junior civil servants) form *adashi* groups. The existence of women's *adashi* groups is briefly noted by Smith (1955) and Nicolas (NM, etc.). (The Batagarawa variety of *adashi* is very similar to the Nupe *dashi* reported on by Nadel (1942); Nupe farmers, unlike urban men in

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other occupations, are never members.) Rotating credit associations are a world-wide institution, the Hausa variety being very common - see Ardener (1964).

See Biki, **Women - economic position of** .

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Agama. Oppression of market vendors by a chief - Bargery. 'Illegal market impost on goods other than meat' - Hiskett (1960, p. 573).

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Exploitation

Agazari. The hot season immediately following the cessation of the rains, which is followed by *dari* . See Kaka, Rani.

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Climate

Age-structure . According to the 1952 population census, only 5% of all males in Mallamawa District were aged over fifty years, the corresponding proportion for females being 10%. Owing to the difficulties of age-estimation, little significance would have been attached to these percentages, had it not been that the proportion of males over fifty was found to be 5%  204 or less in 21 out of 22 Districts in Katsina Emirate. Unless the statistics had been centrally 'adjusted', or abnormal instructions given to the numerous Katsina enumerators, the figures certainly suggest that life expectancies for Katsina males were lower than in northern Nigeria generally. (In 8 out of 12 Northern Provinces the proportion lay between 9% and 11%: it was 4% in Benue and Katsina and 7% in Kabba and Plateau.)

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